DO YOU KNOW?

The first EDI messages was sent in 1965 from the Holland-American steamship line to Trans-Atlantic shipping company using telex messages. The computer had sent a full page of information in roughly 2 minutes. These messages were then written on the magnetic tapes that could be loaded onto another computer.

18.2 EDI Types

The types of EDI were constructed based on how EDI communication connections and the conversion were organized. Thus based on the medium used for transmitting EDI documents the following are the major EDI types.

- Direct EDI
- EDI via VAN
- EDI via FTP/VPN, SFTP, FTPS
- Web EDI
- Mobile EDI

Direct EDI/Point-to-Point

It is also called as Point-to-Point EDI. It establishes a direct connection between various business stakeholders and partners individually. This type of EDI suits to larger businesses with a lot of day to day business transactions.

EDI via VAN

EDI via VAN (Value Added Network) is where EDI documents are transferred with the support of third party network service providers. Many businesses prefer this network model to protect them from the updating ongoing complexities of network technologies. See Figure 18.2

DO YOU KNOW?

A value-added network is a company, that is based on its own network, offering EDI services to other businesses. A value-added network acts as an intermediary between trading partners. The principle operations of value-added networks are the allocation of access rights and providing high data security.

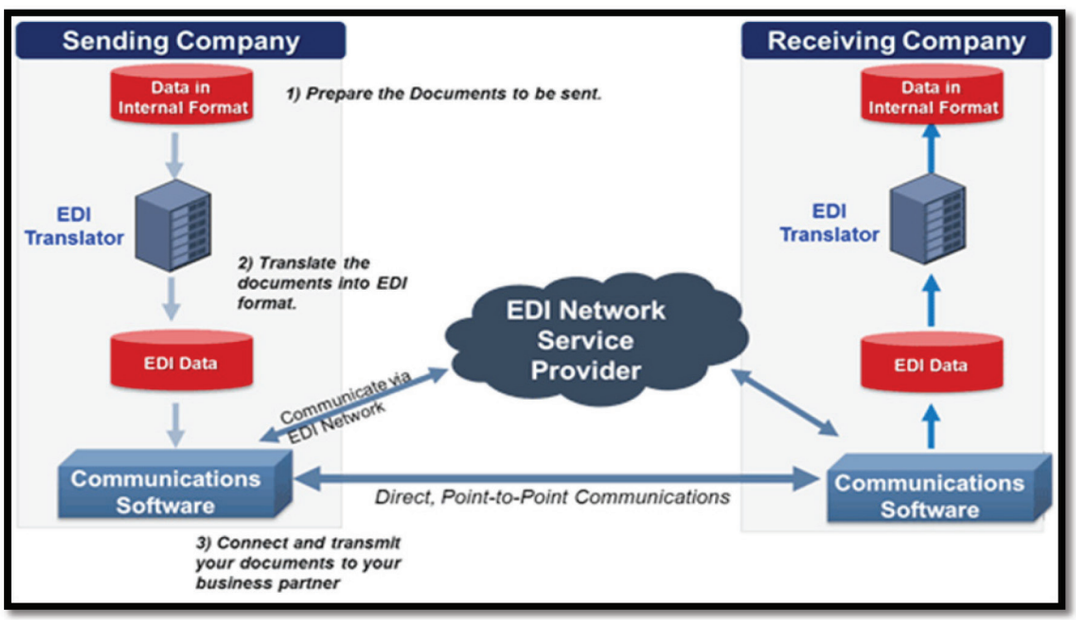


Figure: 18.2 EDI via VAN

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